PITCH · THE KEYBOARD · LEARN

The keyboard

REMEMBER Left is lower, right is higher. C sits just left of every group of two black keys.

1 Twos and threes

★☆☆

Circle every group of two black keys and every group of three. How many of each?

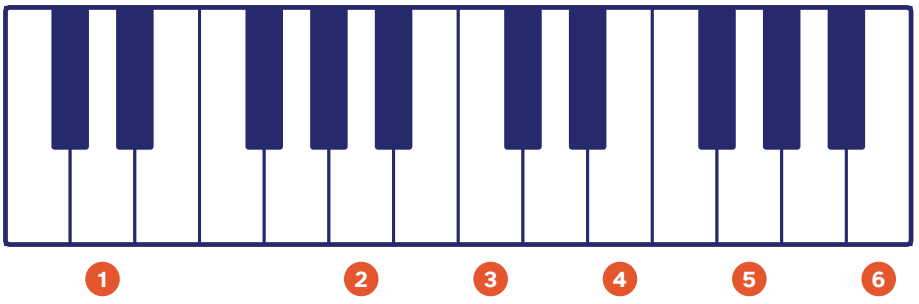


groups of two ____ groups of three ____

2 Name the keys

★☆☆

Write the letter name of each numbered key. The first is done.



1 D 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____

3 The musical alphabet

★☆☆

Write the next three letters: going up the keyboard on the left, going down on the right. The first is done.

GOING UP	GOING DOWN
E F G **A B C**	C B A **G F E**
F G A	G F E
B C D	D C B

Date _____

PITCH · THE KEYBOARD · USE

The keyboard

REMEMBER E–F and B–C have no black key between them: they are semitones.

1 Find them all ★☆☆

Colour every C on this keyboard and mark every F with a dot. How many of each?



Cs ☐ Fs ☐

2 Tone or semitone? ★★☆

Use the keyboard above. Circle T for a tone (two semitones) or S for a semitone (the very next key). The first is done.

E – F	T	(S)	**C – D**	T	S	**B – C**	T	S
F – G	T	S	**A – B**	T	S	**G – A**	T	S

3 Octaves ★☆☆

Complete each sentence.

From one C to the next C there are ☐ white keys, counting both.

From one C to the next C there are ☐ semitones.

The C nearest the middle of the piano is called _____ .

4 Up or down ★★☆

Start on the first key, move as asked, and write the key you land on. The first is done.

E up a semitone	F	**F down a semitone**	☐	**B up a semitone**	☐
C down a semitone	☐	**D up a tone**	☐	**A down a tone**	☐

5 Play it ★☆☆

Play every C from the bottom of the piano to the top, saying “low”, “middle” or “high” as you go. Then every F. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

PITCH · READING THE NOTES · LEARN

The staff and the notes

REMEMBER Count lines and spaces from the bottom. Treble lines E G B D F, spaces F A C E; bass lines G B D F A, spaces A C E G.

1 The clefs

★☆☆

Write the name of each clef and the note it marks.

CLEF	NAME	IT MARKS THE LINE FOR
		
		

2 Line or space?

★☆☆

Circle line or space, then write its number (counted from the bottom). The first is done.

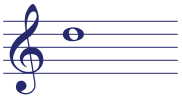


(line) · space

1



line · space



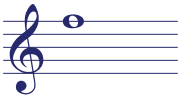
line · space



line · space



line · space



line · space

3 The letters on the staff

★☆☆

Write the letters from the bottom up. The first row is done.

Treble lines	E	G	B	D	F	
Treble spaces						
Bass lines						
Bass spaces						

Date _____

PITCH · READING THE NOTES · USE

The staff and the notes

REMEMBER A step goes from a line to the next space; a skip jumps line to line or space to space.

1 Note words

★★☆

Each group of notes spells a word. Write it underneath. The first is done.





BAG













2 Step or skip?

★☆☆

Circle step or skip. The first is done.



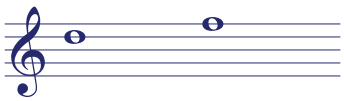
(step) · skip



step · skip



step · skip



step · skip



step · skip



step · skip

Date _____

PITCH · READING THE NOTES · PRACTISE

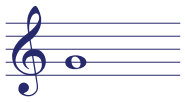
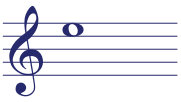
The staff and the notes

REMEMBER Find a landmark note first (middle C, treble G, bass F), then step or skip from it.

1 Treble clef notes

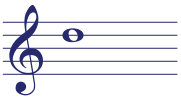
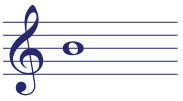
★☆☆

Write the letter name under each note. The first is done.



G


2 Bass clef notes

★★☆

Write the letter name under each note. Careful: the same place has a different name in the bass clef. The first is done.






F






3 Same place, two names

★★☆

The same line or space has a different name in each clef. Write both. The first is done.

PLACE	TREBLE CLEF	BASS CLEF
line 1	E	G
space 2		
line 5		

Date _____

PITCH · READING THE NOTES · PRACTISE

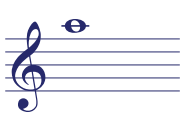
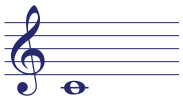
The staff and the notes

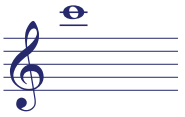
REMEMBER Every note has one place: a line or a space. Draw it right in the middle of its line or space.

1 Ledger lines

★★☆

Name each note above or below the staff. The first is done.



A






2 Draw it

★★☆

Draw each note as a semibreve, in the one place on the staff where it fits.






G on a line | C in a space | E on a line | F in a space






A in a space | B on a line | G on a line | E in a space

3 Name-it race

★★☆

Time yourself naming the eight treble and eight bass notes on page 5, out loud. Write your time each day and watch it fall.

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7
sec	sec	sec	sec	sec	sec	sec

Date _____

PITCH · SHARPS, FLATS AND NATURALS · LEARN

Sharps, flats and naturals

REMEMBER A sharp raises a note a semitone, a flat lowers it, a natural cancels either.

1 The signs

★☆☆

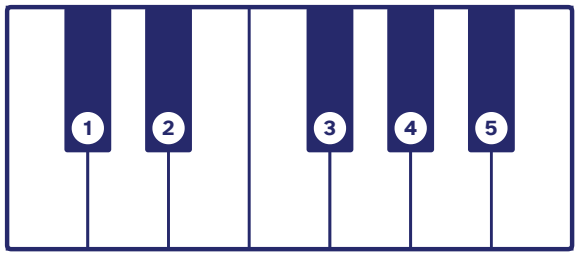
Write the name of each sign and what it does.

SIGN	NAME	WHAT IT DOES
♯		
♭		
♮		

2 Two names for each black key

★★☆

Give each numbered black key its sharp name and its flat name.

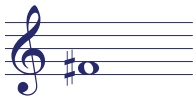


KEY	SHARP NAME	FLAT NAME
1	C♯	D♭
2		
3		
4		
5		

3 Name the notes

★☆☆

Write the full name of each note, with its sharp or flat. The first is done.



F♯















Date _____

PITCH · SHARPS, FLATS AND NATURALS · USE

Sharps, flats and naturals

REMEMBER An accidental lasts until the bar line; the next bar starts fresh.

1 How long does it last?

★★☆

Write the full name of each numbered note.



1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐

2 A semitone away

★★☆

Write the note a semitone higher and a semitone lower. Use the keyboard on page 7 if you need it.

NOTE	A SEMITONE HIGHER	A SEMITONE LOWER
C	C♯	B
E		
F		
B		
G		

3 Same sound, new name

★★☆

Write another name for each note (an enharmonic).

C♯ = ☐ E♭ = ☐ G♭ = ☐

A♯ = ☐ E♯ = ☐ C♭ = ☐

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a sharp		☐
a flat		☐
a natural		☐
an accidental cancelled by a bar line		☐

Date

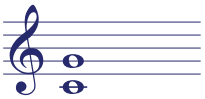
PITCH · INTERVALS · LEARN

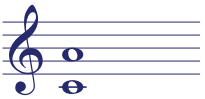
Tones, semitones and intervals

REMEMBER Count letter names, both ends included: C up to E is a 3rd (C D E).

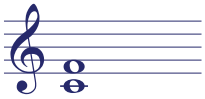
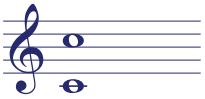
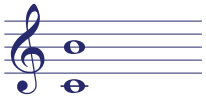
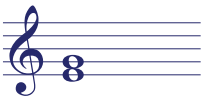
1 Interval numbers ★☆☆

Write the number of each interval (2nd, 3rd, 4th...). The first is done.

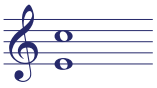
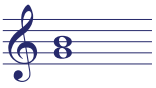


3rd

2 Melodic or harmonic? ★☆☆

Circle melodic (one after the other) or harmonic (together). The first is done.


melodic · harmonic | melodic · harmonic | melodic · harmonic | melodic · harmonic

3 Count the semitones ★★☆

Count every key from the first note to the second, black and white. The first is done.

C up to E 4 semitones | **C up to G** ☐ semitones | **E up to F** ☐ semitones

D up to F ☐ semitones | **C up to C** ☐ semitones | **F up to B** ☐ semitones

4 Your hand measures it ★☆☆

Thumb on C, one finger on each white key above it. Write the interval each finger makes with the thumb.

finger 2 ☐ | **finger 3** ☐ | **finger 4** ☐

finger 5 ☐

Date _____

PITCH · INTERVALS · USE

Tones, semitones and intervals

REMEMBER A major 3rd is four semitones; a minor 3rd is three.

1 Draw the note above

★★☆

Draw a note the given interval above, then write its letter name. The first is done.



a 3rd E



a 5th



a 4th



an octave



a 2nd



a 6th

2 Major or minor 3rd?

★★★

Count the semitones, then circle major or minor.



M · m



M · m



M · m



M · m



M · m



M · m

3 Higher, lower or the same?

★☆☆

Someone plays two notes, one after the other. Circle what the second does. Swap and play for them.

1 higher · lower · same	2 higher · lower · same	3 higher · lower · same
4 higher · lower · same	5 higher · lower · same	6 higher · lower · same

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a harmonic 3rd		
a melodic 5th		
five notes moving by step		

Date

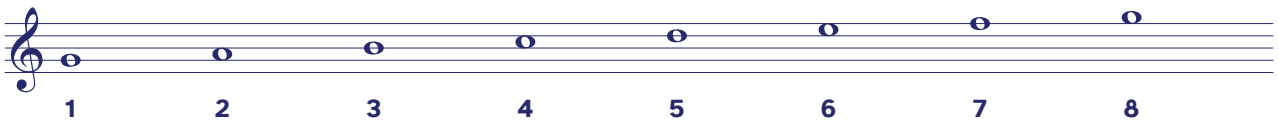
PITCH · SCALES AND KEYS · LEARN

Scales and keys

REMEMBER Every major scale has the same pattern: T T S T T T S.

1 Fix the scale ★★☆

This should be G major, but one note is missing its sharp. Add it, then answer.



the note that needs a sharp ☐ semitones between degrees ☐ – ☐ and ☐ – ☐

2 The major pattern ★☆☆

Write T or S between each pair of degrees.

1 [T] 2 [T] 3 [ ] 4 [ ] 5 [ ] 6 [ ] 7 [ ] 8

3 Degree names ★☆☆

Write the name of each degree.

DEGREE	NAME	DEGREE	NAME
1	tonic	2	
5		3	
4		6	
7			

4 Relative minor ★★☆

Each major key shares its key signature with a minor key, three semitones lower.

C major → **A** minor

G major → ☐ minor

F major → ☐ minor

D major → ☐ minor

B♭ major → ☐ minor

E♭ major → ☐ minor

Date _____

PITCH · SCALES AND KEYS · USE

Scales and keys

REMEMBER The order of sharps: F C G D A E B. The order of flats is the same, backwards.

1 Name the key

★★☆

Write the major key and its relative minor for each key signature. The first is done.



major G minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____



major _____ minor _____

2 Which minor?

★★★

Three forms of A minor, going up. Write natural, harmonic or melodic under each.

A 

_____

B 

_____

C 

_____

3 In order

★☆☆

Write the order of sharps and the order of flats.

Sharps ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Flats ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play each scale one octave, hands separately. Tick a circle each day it is even and correct.

G major ○ ○ ○ ○ **F major** ○ ○ ○ ○ **A harmonic minor** ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

PITCH · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 15.

1 Name the notes ★☆☆

Write the full name of each note.

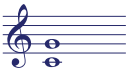





_____ _____ _____ _____

2 Intervals and keys ★★☆

Write the interval number for the first two; the major key for the last two.






interval interval

_____ _____ major _____ major _____

3 Complete it ★★☆

One word or letter in each space.

A semitone higher than E is [ ] .

From C to the next C there are [ ] white keys, counting both.

A natural sign _____ a sharp or flat.

The relative minor of G major is [ ] minor.

4 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

E to F is a tone.	T	F
A key signature applies to every line of the piece.	T	F
An accidental lasts until the end of the bar.	T	F

Score [ ] **/ 15**

Date _____

PITCH · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
the keyboard and the musical alphabet	☐	☐	☐	p. 22
tones and semitones	☐	☐	☐	p. 32
the staff and the clefs	☐	☐	☐	p. 24
treble clef notes	☐	☐	☐	p. 26
bass clef notes	☐	☐	☐	p. 26
ledger lines	☐	☐	☐	p. 24
sharps, flats and naturals	☐	☐	☐	p. 30
enharmonic names	☐	☐	☐	p. 30
interval numbers	☐	☐	☐	p. 32
major and minor 3rds	☐	☐	☐	p. 34
major scales	☐	☐	☐	p. 36
minor scales	☐	☐	☐	p. 38
key signatures	☐	☐	☐	p. 40

Teacher's note

Date _____

PITCH · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Groups (A to G, three octaves): twos 3, threes 2 (count whole groups only: a single black key at each end is part of a cut-off group). Keys: 1 D, 2 A, 3 C, 4 E, 5 G, 6 B. Alphabet: B C D · D C B · E F G · A G F.
p. 2	Cs 3, Fs 3. T/S: S, T, S, T, T, T. Octave: 8 white keys, 12 semitones, middle C. Up or down: F, E, C, B, E, G.
p. 3	Clefs: treble (G clef), line 2 = G; bass (F clef), line 4 = F. Line or space: line 1, space 2, line 4, space 3, line 2, line 5. Letters: treble spaces F A C E; bass lines G B D F A; bass spaces A C E G.
p. 4	Words: BAG, FACE, EGG, CAGE, BED, CAFE, BAD, CAGE. Step or skip: step, skip, step, skip, skip, step.
p. 5	Treble: G E A C F D B E. Bass clef: F A C G E B D A. Two names: space 2 treble A, bass C; line 5 treble F, bass A.
p. 6	Ledger lines: A, C, B, C · C, E, B, D. Draw it: treble G line 2, C space 3, E line 1, F space 1; bass A space 1, B line 2, G line 1, E space 3.
p. 7	Signs: sharp, raises a semitone; flat, lowers a semitone; natural, cancels a sharp or flat. Black keys: 2 D♯/E♭, 3 F♯/G♭, 4 G♯/A♭, 5 A♯/B♭. Notes: F♯, B♭, C♯, E♭, G♯, A♭, F♯, B♭.
p. 8	Bar: 1 F♯, 2 G, 3 F♯, 4 F (natural), 5 F. Semitone higher / lower: E: F / E♭ · F: F♯ / E · B: C / B♭ · G: G♯ / G♭ (enharmonic names also correct). Enharmonics: D♭, D♯, F♯, B♭, F, B.
p. 9	Numbers: 3rd, 5th, 2nd, 6th, 4th, octave, 7th, 3rd. Melodic, harmonic, harmonic, melodic. Semitones: 4, 7, 1, 3, 12, 6. Hand: 2nd, 3rd, 4th, 5th.
p. 10	Note above: E, A, B, E, A, F. 3rds: 4 M, 3 m, 3 m, 4 M, 4 M, 3 m.
p. 11	F needs a sharp (F♯); semitones 3–4 and 7–8. Pattern: T T S T T T S. Degrees: 2 supertonic, 3 mediant, 4 subdominant, 5 dominant, 6 submediant, 7 leading note. Relative minors: E, D, B, G, C.
p. 12	Keys: G / E minor · F / D minor · D / B minor · B♭ / G minor · A / F♯ minor · E♭ / C minor. Minor forms: A harmonic, B natural, C melodic. Sharps F C G D A E B; flats B E A D G C F.
p. 13	E, C, F♯, G · 5th, 3rd, D major, F major · F, 8, cancels, E · F, T, T.

"Draw it", "in your music", listening and playing have no single answer to copy: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____

TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · LEARN

Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER Beats are grouped into bars; beat 1 of every bar is the strongest.

1 Strong beats ★☆☆

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar. In 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4



3/4



4/4



2 Name the signs ★☆☆

Write the name of each sign and what it tells you.

SIGN	NAME	IT TELLS YOU
		
		
		

3 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold. The first bar is done.



4 Slow to fast ★☆☆

Number the marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4). The first is done.

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
4			

5 How fast does it feel? ★☆☆

About **60** is slow (a clock's tick); about **120** is fast. Try a metronome and write the number that feels like each.

a slow walk ♩ = ☐

marching ♩ = ☐

running ♩ = ☐

Date _____

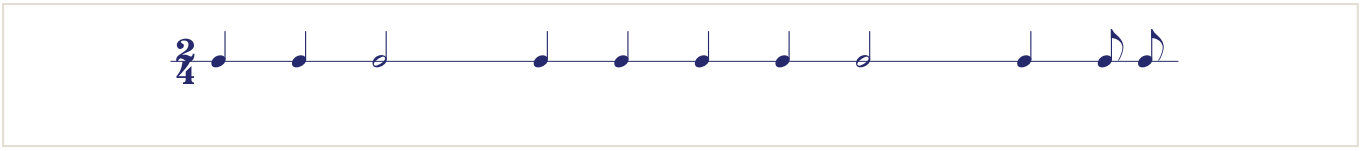
TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · USE

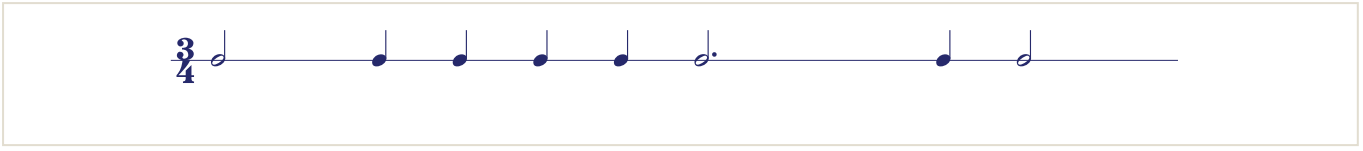
Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER A long note still has every one of its beats counted.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

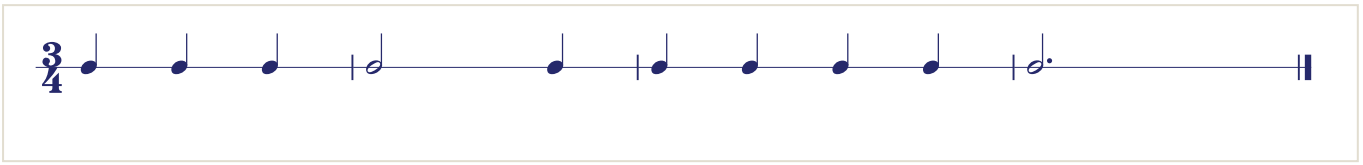
Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.





2 Spot the mistake ★★☆

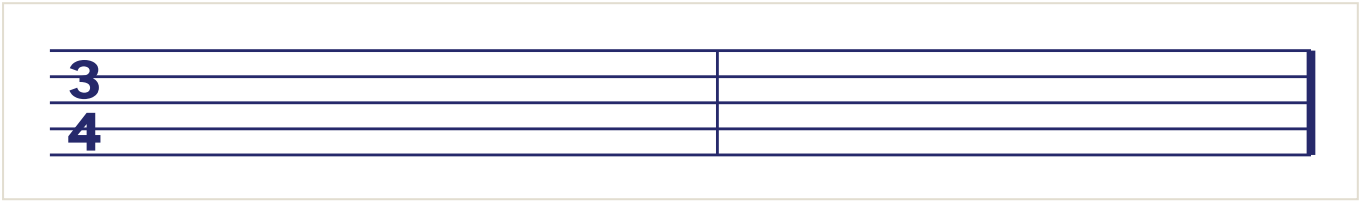
One bar has the wrong number of beats. Circle it and write how many beats it has.



beats in the wrong bar ☐

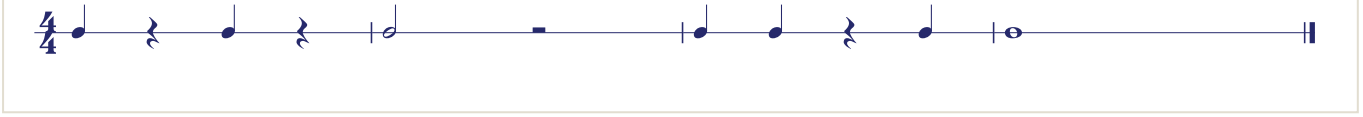
3 Make your own ★★★

Write two bars of 3/4 using crotchets and minims. Clap them while counting, then play them on one note.



4 Clap and count ★☆☆

Set a metronome to ♩ = 60. Clap on the notes, open your hands on the rests, count aloud. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · LEARN

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Each plain note lasts half as long as the one above it; every note has a rest of the same length.

1 Name, beats and rest

★☆☆

Write each note's name and beats (crotchet = 1 beat), then draw the rest of the same length. The first row is done.

NOTE	NAME	BEATS	REST
𝅝	**semibreve**	**4**	𝄻
♩	_____	☐	☐
𝅗𝅥	_____	☐	☐
♪	_____	☐	☐
♩.	_____	☐	☐
𝅘𝅥𝅯	_____	☐	☐

2 Draw it

★★☆

Draw one note for each length (crotchet = 1 beat).

2 beats	½ beat	3 beats	4 beats
☐	☐	☐	☐

3 Why a whole note?

★☆☆

One pizza = one beat. The note that fills all four pizzas of a 4/4 bar is the **whole note**; shorter notes cut one pizza into pieces. Colour each share, write the other name and the beats.

𝅝 **semibreve**		whole note	4 beats
𝅗𝅥 **minim**		_____	_____ beats
♩ **crotchet**		_____	_____ beats
♪ **quaver**		_____	_____ beats
𝅘𝅥𝅯 **semiquaver**		_____	_____ beats

Date _____

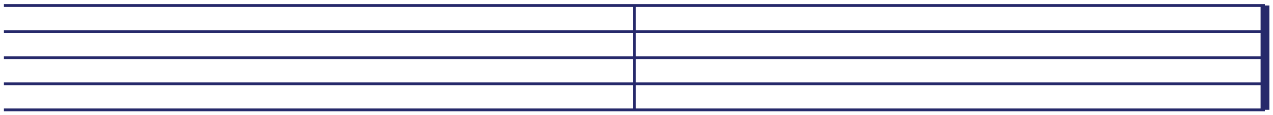
TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · USE

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Below the middle line, stems go up on the right; above it, down on the left.

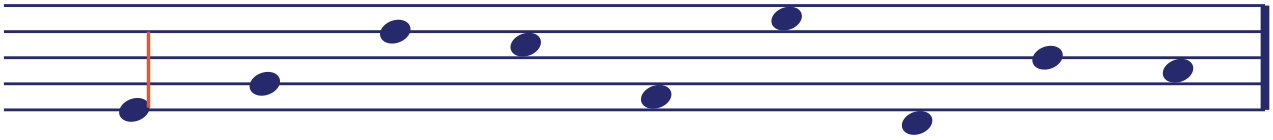
1 Rests on the staff ★☆☆

Draw a semibreve rest in the first bar (it hangs below the fourth line) and a minim rest in the second (it sits on the middle line).



2 Draw the stems ★★☆

Turn every head into a crotchet: add a stem going the right way. The first is done.



3 Finish with a rest ★★☆

Each bar is short. Complete it with one rest. The first is done.



rest **minim rest** rest _____ rest _____ rest _____

4 Rests are empty slices ★☆☆

A rest is silence that lasts as long as its note. Shade each rest's share of the pizzas with lines, then write its beats. The first is done.

semibreve rest		**4 beats**
minim rest		_____ beats
crotchet rest		_____ beats
quaver rest		_____ beats

Date _____

TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · LEARN

How long is a note?

REMEMBER A dot adds half the note's value; a tie joins two notes of the same pitch into one sound.

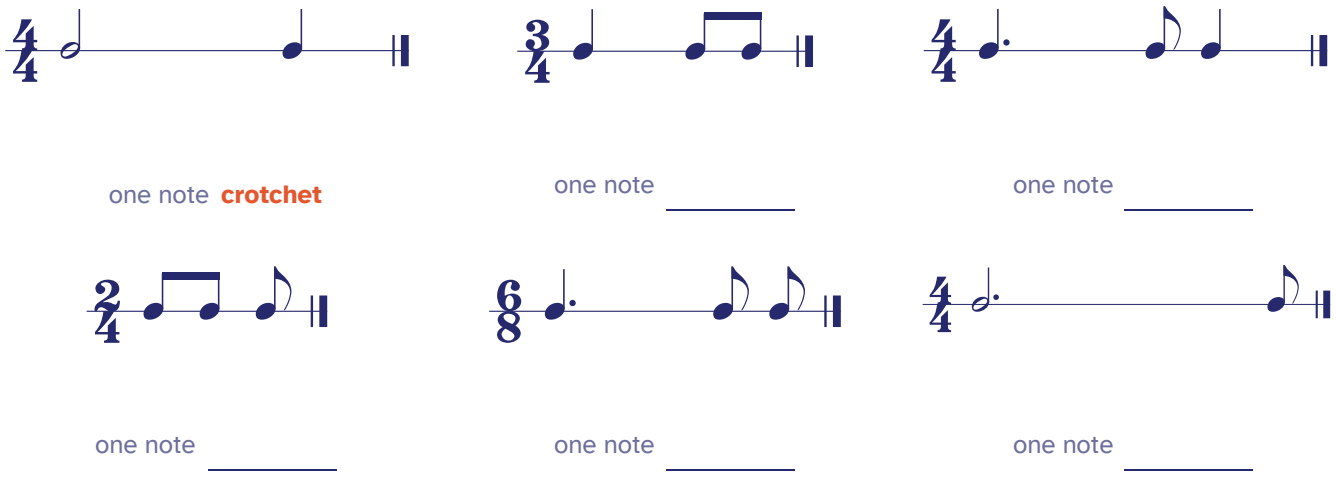
1 Note sums ★☆☆

Add up the beats (crotchet = 1 beat). The first one is done.



2 Complete the bar ★★☆

Each bar is one note short. Count the beats you have, then find what is missing. The first is done: 4/4 needs 4 beats; minim 2 + crotchet 1 = 3, so **1 beat** is missing: a crotchet.



one note **crotchet**

one note _____

one note _____

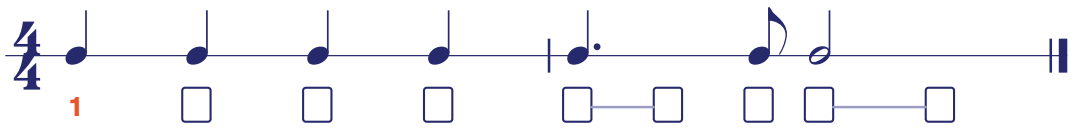
one note _____

one note _____

one note _____

3 Ode to Joy: count it ★★☆

Bars 3–4 of Beethoven's Ode to Joy (Handbook p. 53). Write a count in every box, then sing it as you clap. The first is done.



Date _____

TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · USE

How long is a note?

REMEMBER A tie can cross a bar line; a dot cannot.

1 Tie or dot?

★★☆

Each tie makes one sound. Write the one dotted note that lasts the same. The first is done.



dotted note **dotted minim**



dotted note _____



dotted note _____

2 Spot the mistake

★★☆

One bar does not add up to four beats. Circle it and write how many beats it has.



beats in the wrong bar ☐

3 Clap and count

★☆☆

Clap the dotted rhythms, counting the "&" inside each dotted crotchet. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a dotted minim		
a dotted crotchet		
a tie		
a rest of one whole bar		

Date _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · LEARN

Time signatures

REMEMBER Top number: how many counts in a bar. Bottom number: which note is one count.

1 Which time signature?

★☆☆

Each line is one full bar. Write a time signature that fits. The first is done.



time signature 3/4



time signature _____



time signature _____



time signature _____



time signature _____



time signature _____

2 Simple or compound?

★★☆

Circle simple or compound, then write how many beats are in each bar. The first is done.

$\frac{3}{4}$	(simple) · compound	beats 3	$\frac{6}{8}$	simple · compound	beats
$\frac{2}{2}$	simple · compound	beats	$\frac{9}{8}$	simple · compound	beats
$\frac{4}{4}$	simple · compound	beats	$\frac{12}{8}$	simple · compound	beats
$\frac{3}{8}$	simple · compound	beats	$\frac{6}{4}$	simple · compound	beats

3 What does it mean?

★☆☆

Complete each sentence.

In 3/4 there are ____ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

In 6/8 there are ____ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

C means the same as ____ ; ¢ means the same as ____ .

Date _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · USE

Time signatures

REMEMBER In compound time each beat is a dotted note, divided into three.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

Draw a bar line after every full bar, and a final bar line at the end.



2 Beam them ★★★

The same six quavers in two time signatures. Join them with beams to show the beats: in twos for 3/4, in threes for 6/8.

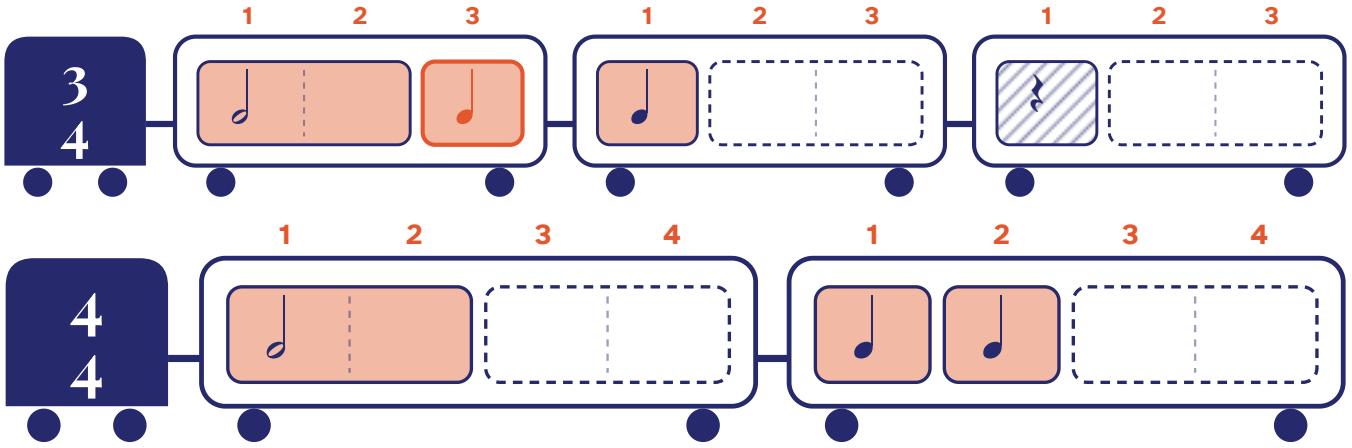


3 beats

2 beats

3 Book every seat ★★☆

Each carriage is one bar of the time signature on the engine. Draw one note or rest in the dashed seats so every seat is booked. The first is done.



Date _____

TIME · COMPOUND AND IRREGULAR TIME · LEARN

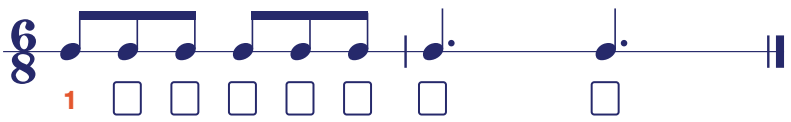
Compound and irregular time

REMEMBER In 6/8 each beat is a dotted crotchet, split into three: count 1 2 3 4 5 6, feel two.

1 Count 6/8

★☆☆

Write a count in every box. The first is done.



2 3/4 or 6/8?

★★☆

Both bars hold six quavers. Look at the beams and write the time signature. The first is done.



time signature 3/4

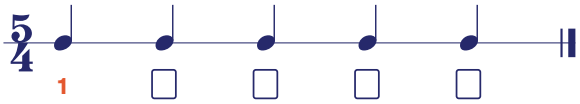


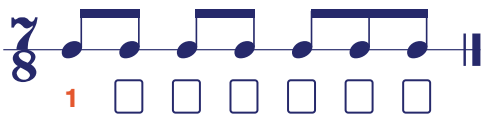
time signature _____

3 Uneven bars

★★☆

Count 5/4 as 3 + 2 and 7/8 as 2 + 2 + 3: write the count in every box. The first of each is done.





4 Beats in compound time

★☆☆

Complete each line: how many dotted-crotchet beats in a bar? The first is done.

6/8	2	beats
9/8		beats
12/8		beats

5 Feel two

★☆☆

Clap six quavers counting 1 2 3 4 5 6, then clap again saying only “1” and “4”. Tick a circle each time the two beats feel steady.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

TIME · COMPOUND AND IRREGULAR TIME · USE

Compound and irregular time

REMEMBER Many dances keep 4/4 but group its eight quavers 3 + 3 + 2.

1 Add the bar lines

★★☆

Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.

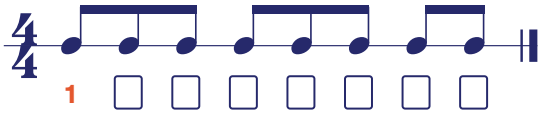




2 3 + 3 + 2

★★☆

Write the count in every box (1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2), then tap it, louder on each 1. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Clap and count

★★☆

Clap with a metronome, counting six quavers, feeling two beats. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning or listening to.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a piece in 6/8		☐
a bar of quavers beamed in threes		☐
a piece in 5/4 or 7/8 (listen: Take Five)		☐

Date _____

TIME · GROUPS AND UPBEATS · LEARN

Groups and upbeats

REMEMBER Beams show the beats: they join the notes of one beat, or in 4/4 of beats 1–2 or 3–4, never across the middle.

1 Good grouping?

★★☆

Circle ✓ if the grouping shows the beats, × if it hides one. The first is done.



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×

2 Cut the beat

★☆☆

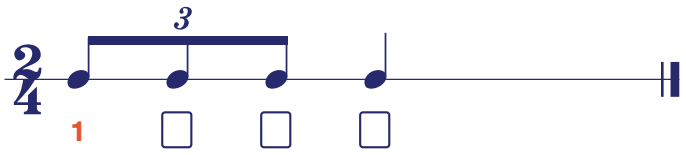
One beat is one pizza. Colour each one, then write how much of a beat each note gets and how you count it. The first is done.

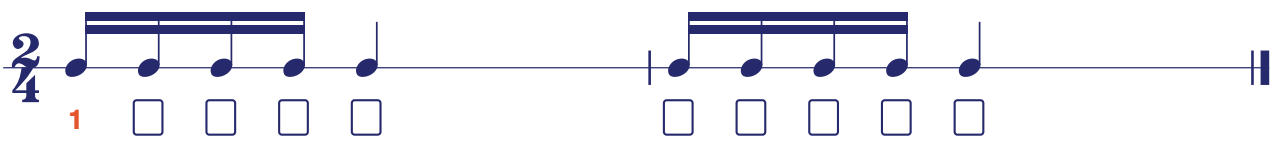
two quavers		half a beat each	1 &
a triplet		_____	_____
four semiquavers		_____	_____

3 Count it

★★☆

Write a count in every box: a triplet (1 & a), then semiquavers (1 e & a). The first of each is done.





Date _____

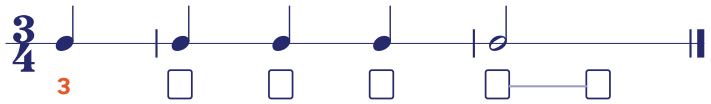
TIME · GROUPS AND UPBEATS · USE

Groups and upbeats

REMEMBER An upbeat and the last bar together make one full bar.

1 The upbeat ★★☆

This piece starts on beat 3 (done for you). Write a count in every other box. Then: how many beats does the last bar need?



beats in the last bar ☐

2 Clap the upbeat ★☆☆

Clap the piece in exercise 1 with a metronome: count “1 2” silently, clap on 3. Tick a circle each time the last bar is exactly two beats.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Clap and count ★★☆

Triplets and semiquavers: clap with a metronome while counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
an upbeat (anacrusis)		
a triplet		
four semiquavers in one beat		

Date _____

TIME · OFF THE BEAT · LEARN

Off the beat

REMEMBER Syncopation: a note that starts between the beats and is held across the next one.

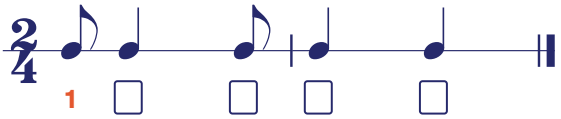
1 Find the off-beat notes ★★☆

Tap the beat. Circle every note that starts on an “&”, between the beats.



2 Count a syncopation ★★☆

Write a count in every box. Keep the beat in your foot. The first is done.



3 Swing ★☆☆

Which line shows how swung quavers are played? Circle A or B, then play both and hear the difference.

A



B



4 Foot and hands ★☆☆

Tap the beat with your foot and clap only on the “&”s. Then swap: clap the beats, tap the “&”s. Tick a circle each time it holds together.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

A syncopated note starts between the beats.	T	F
Swing quavers are written long–short.	T	F
In syncopation the beat stops for a moment.	T	F

Date _____

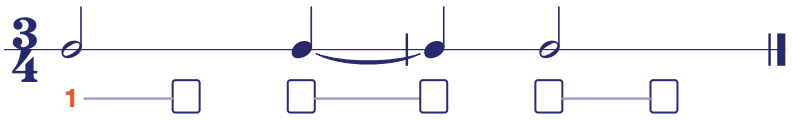
TIME · OFF THE BEAT · USE

Off the beat

REMEMBER Hemiola: two bars of 3/4 felt as three big beats.

1 Hemiola ★★★

Count it in 3/4 in the boxes, then clap it feeling three minims across the two bars.



2 Clap and count ★★☆

Clap the syncopations with a metronome, counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning or listening to.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a syncopation		☐
Swing written at the top		☐

4 Swing it ★★☆

Play a C major scale in swing quavers (“doo-ba, doo-ba”), then straight. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 Listen for it ★☆☆

Listen to each one and tick it when you hear what is listed.

Joplin, The Entertainer	syncopation	○
Miller, In the Mood	swing	○
Bernstein, America	hemiola	○

Date _____

TIME · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 17: one mark for each answer.

1 Name the notes ★☆☆

Write the name of each note.



2 How many beats? ★☆☆

Crotchet = 1 beat.





3 Time signatures ★★☆

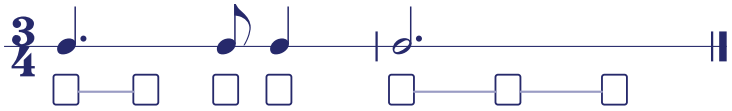
Write a time signature for each bar, then circle the compound ones.



time signature _____ time signature _____ time signature _____

4 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box.



5 True or false? ★★☆

Circle T or F.

A tie joins two notes of different pitches.	T	F
6/8 has two beats in a bar.	T	F
In 4/4, a beam may cross the middle of the bar.	T	F

Score ____ **/ 18**

Date _____

TIME · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
pulse, tempo and strong beats	☐	☐	☐	p. 48
bar lines and repeat signs	☐	☐	☐	p. 48
note and rest values	☐	☐	☐	p. 50
dots and ties	☐	☐	☐	p. 52
simple time signatures	☐	☐	☐	p. 54
compound time (6/8)	☐	☐	☐	p. 56
irregular time (5/4, 7/8)	☐	☐	☐	p. 56
grouping with beams	☐	☐	☐	p. 58
triplets and semiquavers	☐	☐	☐	p. 58
upbeats	☐	☐	☐	p. 58
syncopation	☐	☐	☐	p. 60
swing	☐	☐	☐	p. 60
hemiola	☐	☐	☐	p. 60

Teacher's note

Date _____

TIME · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Slow to fast: 4, 1, 3, 2 (60 slowest, 120 fastest). Strong beats on 1; in 4/4 medium on 3. Signs: bar line, double bar line, final bar line, repeat signs. Count: 1 2 3 · 1–2 3 · 1–2–3. How fast does it feel: any answer; slower to faster is usual.
p. 2	Bar lines: 2/4 after notes 2, 3, 5, 7 and 8, final bar line after note 11; 3/4 after notes 2, 5 and 6, final bar line after note 8. Mistake: bar 3 has 4 beats.
p. 3	Draw it: minim, quaver, dotted minim, semibreve. Table: crotchet 1, crotchet rest; minim 2, minim rest; quaver ½, quaver rest; dotted minim 3, dotted minim rest; semiquaver ¼, semiquaver rest. Why a whole note: minim = half note, 2 beats; crotchet = quarter note, 1 beat; quaver = eighth note, ½ beat; semiquaver = sixteenth note, ¼ beat.
p. 4	Stems: up on the right below the middle line, down on the left above it, either on it. Finish with a rest: minim, crotchet, minim, crotchet. Empty slices: minim rest 2 beats (2 pizzas), crotchet rest 1 beat (1 pizza), quaver rest ½ beat (half a pizza).
p. 5	Sums: 3, 1½, 4, 6, 2, 2. Complete: crotchet, crotchet, crotchet, quaver, quaver, quaver. Ode to Joy: 1 2 3 4 · 1–2 & 3–4.
p. 6	Tie or dot: dotted minim, dotted crotchet, dotted semibreve. Mistake: bar 2 has 5 beats.
p. 7	Time signatures: 3/4, 2/4, 6/8 (3/4 also fits), 4/4, 5/4, 9/8. Compound: 6/8, 9/8, 12/8, 6/4 (beats 2, 3, 4, 2). Simple: 3/4 (3), 2/2 (2), 4/4 (4), 3/8 (3). 3/4: 3 crotchet beats; 6/8: 2 dotted-crotchet beats; C = 4/4, ¢ = 2/2.
p. 8	Bar lines: 3/4 after notes 3, 5 and 6, final bar line after note 9; 4/4 after notes 3 and 7, final bar line after note 8. Beams: 3/4 in three pairs; 6/8 in two groups of three. Seats: 3/4 carriage 1 a crotchet, carriage 2 a minim, carriage 3 a minim (or a minim rest); 4/4 carriage 1 a minim (or a minim rest), carriage 2 a minim (or a minim rest).
p. 9	6/8: 1 2 3 4 5 6 · 1 4. Beams: 3/4 (pairs), 6/8 (threes). 5/4: 1 2 3 1 2. 7/8: 1 2 1 2 1 2 3. Compound beats: 6/8 2, 9/8 3, 12/8 4.
p. 10	Bar lines: 9/8 after the 3rd and 8th notes; 5/4 after the 4th and 9th notes. 3 + 3 + 2: 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2.
p. 11	Grouping: ✓ × ✓ ×. Pizza: a triplet, a third of a beat each, 1 & a; four semiquavers, a quarter each, 1 e & a. Triplet: 1 & a 2. Semiquavers: 1 e & a 2 · 1 e & a 2.
p. 12	Upbeat: 3 · 1 2 3 · 1–2; the last bar needs 2 beats.
p. 13	Off the beat: bar 1 notes 3 and 4; bar 2 note 2; bar 3 notes 2 and 3. Syncopation: 1 & & 1 2. Swing is played as B. True or false: T, F, F.
p. 14	Hemiola: 1–2 3 · 1 2–3; felt as three minims.
p. 15	minim, quaver, dotted crotchet, semibreve · 4, 4 · 6/8 (3/4 also fits), 5/4, 9/8 (compound: 6/8 and 9/8) · 1–2 & 3 · 1–2–3 · F, T, F.

Pages with “make your own”, “in your music” and clapping have no single answer: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____

HARMONY · CHORDS AND TRIADS · LEARN

Chords and triads

REMEMBER A triad is three notes stacked in 3rds: root, 3rd, 5th. Play one, skip one.

1 Build it

★☆☆

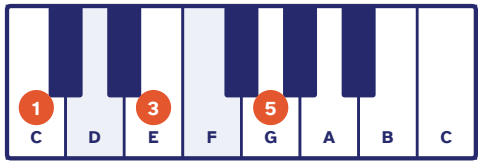
Write the 3rd and the 5th above each root: play one, skip one. The first row is done.

ROOT	3RD	5TH	ROOT	3RD	5TH
C	E	G	G		
D			A		
F			B		

2 On the keyboard

★☆☆

Mark the root, 3rd and 5th of the F triad with 1, 3 and 5. The C triad is done.



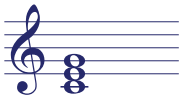


C triad C E G **F triad**

3 Name the triad

★☆☆

Write the root of each triad: the bottom note names it. The first is done.



C











4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C, F and G triads, solid then broken, each hand alone. Tick a circle each clean day.

C triad ○ ○ ○ ○ **F triad** ○ ○ ○ ○ **G triad** ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

HARMONY · CHORDS AND TRIADS · USE

Chords and triads

REMEMBER A stacked triad sits on three lines in a row or in three spaces in a row.

1 Lines or spaces?

★☆☆

Circle lines or spaces for each triad. The first is done.



(lines) · spaces



lines · spaces



lines · spaces

2 Is it a triad?

★★☆

Circle ✓ if the chord is stacked in 3rds, × if it is not. The first is done.



(✓) · ×



✓ · ×



✓ · ×

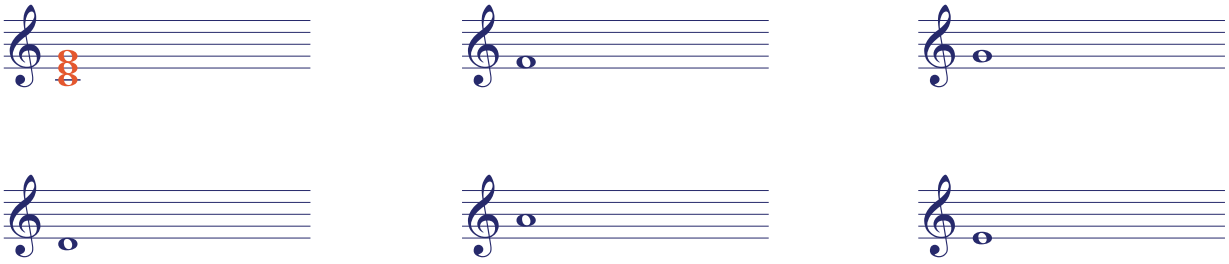


✓ · ×

3 Draw it

★★☆

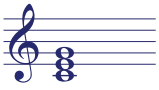
Draw the 3rd and the 5th above each root, as semibreves stacked on top of it. The first is done.



4 Solid or broken?

★☆☆

Circle solid or broken. The first is done.



(solid) · broken



solid · broken



solid · broken



solid · broken

Date _____

HARMONY · FOUR KINDS OF TRIAD · LEARN

Four kinds of triad

REMEMBER Count the keys in between, black and white: major 3 + 2, minor 2 + 3, diminished 2 + 2, augmented 3 + 3.

1 Count the keys between

★☆☆

Count the keys you skip, black and white: root to 3rd, then 3rd to 5th. Then write the kind. The first row is done.

TRIAD	ROOT TO 3RD	3RD TO 5TH	KIND
C E G	3	2	major
A C E			
G B D			
E G B			
B D F			

2 Which kind?

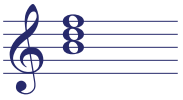
★★☆

Write major, minor, dim or aug under each triad. The first is done.



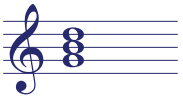
minor











3 Major to minor

★☆☆

Lower the 3rd by a semitone to make each major triad minor. The first is done.

MAJOR	MINOR
C E G	C E♭ G
F A C	
G B D	
D F♯ A	

Date _____

HARMONY · FOUR KINDS OF TRIAD · USE

Four kinds of triad

REMEMBER Keys in between: major 3 + 2, minor 2 + 3.

1 Draw major and minor ★★☆

Draw a triad above each root: major on the top row, minor on the bottom row. Watch for sharps and flats. The first is done.



major



major



major



minor



minor



minor

2 Bright or dark? ★☆☆

Play each triad and circle what you hear. The first is done.

C E G	(bright) · dark
A C E	bright · dark
G B D	bright · dark
D F A	bright · dark

3 Sort the white keys ★★☆

Write the kind of each white-key triad. The first is done.

TRIAD ON	C	D	E	F	G	A	B
Kind	major						

4 Play the four kinds ★☆☆

Play C major, C minor, C diminished and C augmented, each hand alone. Tick a circle each day.

C major	○	○	○	○	**C minor**	○	○	○	○
C diminished	○	○	○	○	**C augmented**	○	○	○	○

Date _____

HARMONY · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Build it: C E G · D F A · F A C · G B D · A C E · B D F. Keyboard: F A C. Name the triad: C, F, G, D, A, E.
p. 2	Lines or spaces: lines, spaces, lines. Is it a triad: ✓, ×, ✓, ×. Draw it: C E G, F A C, G B D, D F A, A C E, E G B. Solid or broken: solid, broken, solid, broken.
p. 3	Keys between: C E G 3 + 2 major · A C E 2 + 3 minor · G B D 3 + 2 major · E G B 2 + 3 minor · B D F 2 + 2 diminished. Which kind: minor, major, dim, aug, minor, major. Major to minor: C E♭ G · F A♭ C · G B♭ D · D F A.
p. 4	Draw: major D F♯ A, A C♯ E, E G♯ B; minor C E♭ G, G B♭ D, F A♭ C. Bright or dark: bright, dark, bright, dark. White keys: C major, D minor, E minor, F major, G major, A minor, B diminished.

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